

# Pradan

**Founded: 1983**

**Sector:** Rural Livelihoods,  
Women's Collectives,  
Natural Resource Management,  
Tribal Development

PRADAN (Professional Assistance for Development Action) was established in 1983 by Deep Joshi and Vijay Mahajan, who believed that even the most stubborn, endemic poverty of rural India could be solved if educated, empathetic professionals worked directly alongside the poor.

Working in the poorest tribal and Dalit regions of central and eastern India, PRADAN places professionals in villages to organise women into Self-Help Groups and federations, build livelihoods on land, water, forests and livestock, and help communities claim rights and entitlements. Its SHG model, pioneered in 1987, went on to shape DAY-NRLM — India's flagship rural livelihoods mission.

Rural & Tribal Poverty

Women's Collectives &  
Agency

Land, Water & Natural  
Resource Degradation

Livelihoods & Market Access

Professionalising Grassroots  
Development

As on 31st March 2025, PRADAN, along with its partners worked with 3.4 million households spread across 42,500 villages, in 675 community development blocks, 140 districts, and 9 states of India.

Individuals Reached

**5 million**

Socio-economic Profile

**65%**

of the individuals we work with belong to Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs) from the economically weakest sections in rural and tribal India.

Households (direct reach)

**~1 million**

Revenue Villages

**9,767**

States

**8**

Districts

**42**

Village Organizations

**5,400**

Federations of SHGs and other collectives

**256**

(Block Level and Cluster Level Federations)

**Highlight**

Across seven states, village communities led by their women's SHGs mobilized more than

**INR 2,178 million  
(US\$27 m)**

under Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS) to create infrastructure for themselves as well as for their villages.

Total Staff

**1,177**

Development Apprentices

**62**

Partners

Foundations & Multilaterals

**25**

Corporates

**8**

Government Departments (Central & State)

**19**

Research Institutes

**5**

Civil Society Organizations

**116**

